

Preliminaries

- We consider the following set of equations

$$\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{b}$$

$$\mathbf{A}(m \times n); \mathbf{x}(n \times 1); \mathbf{b}(m \times 1)$$

- Generalized linear equations can be represented in the above format.
- m and n are the number of equations and variables respectively.
- $\mathbf{b}$ is the general RHS commonly used



Categorization

$$m = n$$

- Number of equations and variables are the same
- Easiest case to solve

$$m > n$$

- More equations than variables
- Usually no solution

$$m < n$$

- Number of equations less than number of variables
- Usually multiple solutions

We look into these cases independently



Full row and column rank: Concepts

- Consider a matrix data matrix A ($m \times n$)

Full Row Rank

- When all the rows of the matrix are linearly independent
- Data sampling does not present a linear relationship – samples are independent

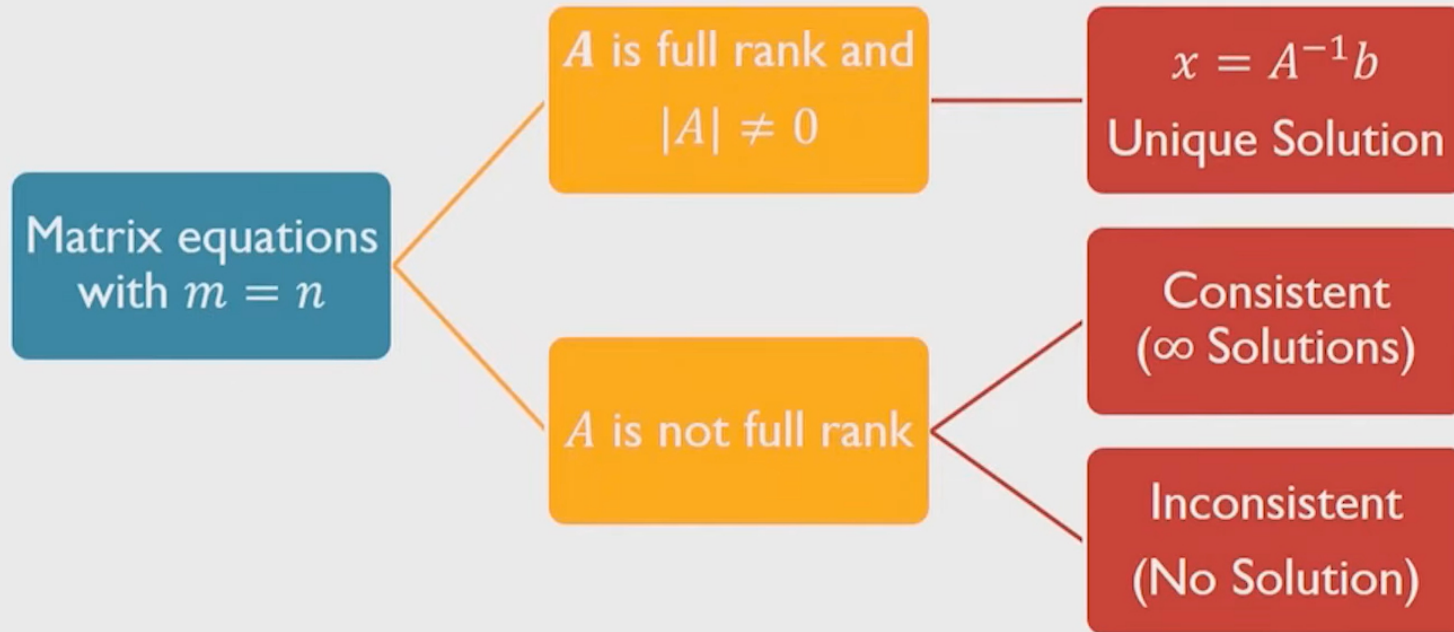
Full Column Rank

- When all the columns of the matrix are linearly independent
- Attributes are linearly independent

Row rank = Column rank



Case 1: $m = n$



Case 1: Example 1.1

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 7 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix}$$

R Code

```
A=matrix(c(1,2,3,4),ncol=2, byrow=F)
b=c(7,10)
x=solve(A)%*%b
```

$$|A| \neq 0$$

$$\text{rank}(A) = 2 = \text{no. of columns}$$

- This implies that A is full rank

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix}^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} 7 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 1.5 \\ 1 & -0.5 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 7 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Thus, the solution for the given example is $(x_1, x_2) = (1, 2)$

Console output

```
> x
      [,1]
[1,]  1
[2,]  2
```



Case 1: Example 1.2

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$|A| = 0; \text{rank}(A) = 1; \text{nullity} = 1$$

- Checking consistency

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 + 2x_2 \\ 2x_1 + 4x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\text{Row}(2) = 2\text{Row}(1)$$

- The equations are consistent with only one linearly independent equation
- The solution set for (x_1, x_2) is infinite because we have only one linearly independent equation and 2 variables

Case 1: Example 1.3

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 \\ 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$|A| = 0$$

$$\text{rank}(A) = 1$$

$$\text{nullity} = 1$$

- Checking consistency

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 + 2x_2 \\ 2x_1 + 4x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 \\ 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$2\text{Row}(1) = 2x_1 + 4x_2 = 10 \neq 9$$

- Thus the equations are inconsistent
- One cannot find a solution to (x_1, x_2)

Case 2: $m > n$

- This is the case of not enough variables or attributes
- Since the number of equations is greater than the number of variables, in general, not all equations can be satisfied
- Hence it is sometimes termed as a no-solution case
- However, we can identify an appropriate solution by viewing this case from an optimization perspective

Case 2: An optimization perspective

- Instead of identifying a solution to $Ax - b = 0$, one can identify an x such that $(Ax - b)$ is minimized
- Notice that $(Ax - b)$ is a vector
- There will be as many error terms as the number of equations
- Denote $(Ax - b) = e(mx1)$; there are m errors $e_i, i = 1:m$
- One could minimize all the errors collectively by minimizing $\sum_{i=1}^m e_i^2$
- This is the same as minimizing $(Ax - b)^T (Ax - b)$



Case 2: An optimization perspective

- This optimization problem is

$$\begin{aligned} & \min[(Ax - b)^T(Ax - b)] \\ & = \min[(b^T - x^T A^T)(Ax - b)] \\ & = \min[(x^T A^T Ax - 2b^T Ax + b^T b) = f(x)] \end{aligned}$$

- We observe that the optimization problem is a function of x
- Solving the optimization problem will result in a solution for x
- The solution to this optimization problem is obtained by differentiating $f(x)$ with respect to x and setting the differential to zero

$$\nabla f(x) = 0$$



Case 2: An optimization perspective

- Differentiating $f(x)$ and setting the differential to zero results in

$$\begin{aligned}2(A^T A)x - 2A^T b &= 0 \\(A^T A)x &= A^T b\end{aligned}$$

- Assuming that all the columns are linearly independent

$$x = (A^T A)^{-1} A^T b$$

Case 2: Example - I

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -0.5 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

- $m = 3, n = 2$
- Using the optimization concept,

$$\mathbf{x} = (\mathbf{A}^T \mathbf{A})^{-1} \mathbf{A}^T \mathbf{b}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -0.5 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

Case 2: Example continued

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.2 & -0.6 \\ -0.6 & 2.8 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 15 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Thus, the solution for the given example is $(x_1, x_2) = (0, 5)$
- Substituting in the equation shows

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix} \neq \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -0.5 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

Case 2: Example

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

- $m = 3, n = 2$
- Using the optimization concept,

$$\mathbf{x} = (\mathbf{A}^T \mathbf{A})^{-1} \mathbf{A}^T \mathbf{b}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$[x_2]$$

$$[-0.6]$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Thus, the solution for t
 $(x_1, x_2) = (1, 2)$

Case 2: Example continued

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.2 & -0.6 \\ -0.6 & 2.8 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 20 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Thus, the solution for the given example is $(x_1, x_2) = (1, 2)$
- Substituting in the equation shows

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

R Code

```
A=matrix(c(1,2,3,0,0,1),ncol=2, byrow=F)
b=matrix(c(1,2,5),ncol=2, byrow=F)
x=inv(t(A)%*%A)%*%t(A)%*%b
x
```

Console output

```
> x=inv(t(A)%*%A)%*%t(A)%*%b
> x
      [,1]
[1,]  1
[2,]  2
>
```



Case 3: $m < n$

- This case addresses the problem of more attributes or variables than equations
- Since the number of attributes is greater than the number of equations, one can obtain multiple solutions for the attributes
- This is termed as an infinite-solution case
- How does one choose a single solution from the set of infinite possible solutions?



Case 3: An optimization perspective

- Pose the following optimization problem

$$\min \left(\frac{1}{2} x^T x \right) \text{ s.t. } Ax = b$$

- Define a Lagrangian function $f(x, \lambda)$

$$\min \left[f(x, \lambda) = \frac{1}{2} x^T x + \lambda^T (Ax - b) \right]$$

- Differentiating the Lagrangian with respect to x , and setting to zero

$$x + A^T \lambda = 0$$



Case 3: An optimization perspective

$$x = -A^T \lambda$$

Pre-multiplying by A

$$Ax = b = -AA^T \lambda$$

Thus we obtain $\lambda = -(AA^T)^{-1}b$ assuming that all the rows are linearly independent

$$x = -A^T \lambda = A^T (AA^T)^{-1} b$$



Case 3: Example

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- $m = 2, n = 3$
- Using the optimization concept,

$$x = A^T (A A^T)^{-1} b$$
$$x = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$



Case 3: Example

$$x = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 14 & 3 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$x = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -0.2 \\ 1.6 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -0.2 \\ -0.4 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- The solution for the given example is $(x_1, x_2, x_3) = (-0.2, -0.4, 1)$

R Code

```
A=matrix(c(1,0,2,0,3,1),ncol=3)
b=c(2,1)
library(MASS)
x = t(A)%*%inv(A%*%t(A)) %*%b
x
```

Console output

```
A=matrix(c(1,0,2,0,3,1),ncol=3, byrow=F)
b=c(2,1)
x = t(A)%*%inv(A%*%t(A)) %*%b
x
```



Case 3: Example

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- The solution for the given example is $(x_1, x_2, x_3) = (-0.2, -0.4, 1)$
- Verify this is a solution that satisfies the original equation
- This also turns out to be minimum norm solution



Generalization

- The described cases cover all the scenarios one might encounter while solving linear equations
- Is there any form in which the results obtained for cases 1, 2 and 3 can be generalized ?
- The concept we used to generalize the solutions is called as Moore-Penrose pseudo-inverse of a matrix
- The pseudo inverse is used as follows

$$Ax = b$$

The solution becomes

$$x = A^+b$$

- Singular Value Decomposition can be used to calculate the pseudo inverse or the generalized inverse (A^+)

Two examples revisited

Example 2

R Code

```
A=matrix(c(1,2,3,0,0,1),ncol=2, byrow=F)
b=matrix(c(1,2,5),ncol=1, byrow=F)
library(MASS)
x= ginv(A)%*%b
```

Solution

```
> x [,1]
[1,] 1
[2,] 2
```

Example 3

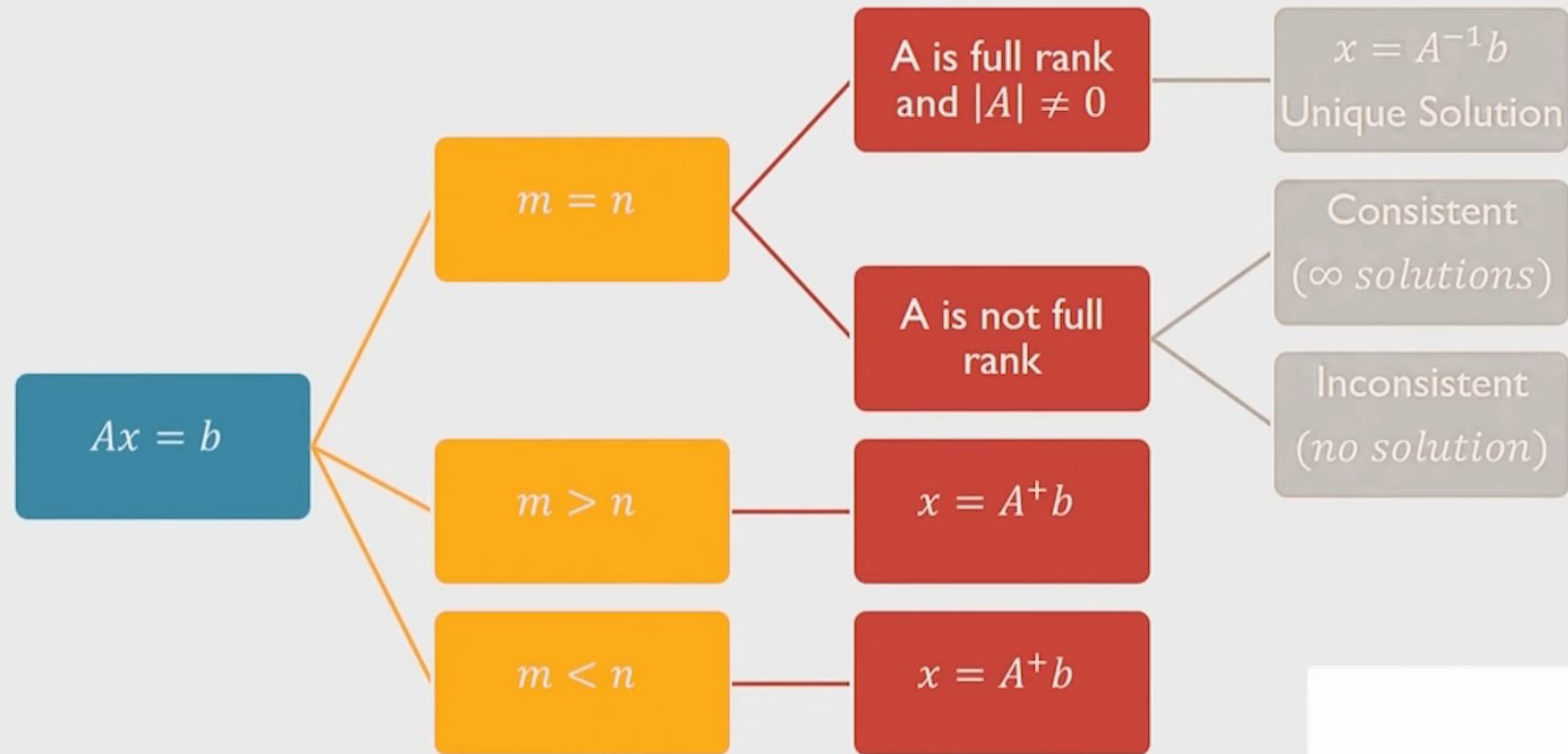
R Code

```
A=matrix(c(1,0,2,0,3,1),ncol=3, byrow=F)
b=c(2,1)
library(MASS)
x = ginv(A)%*%b
```

Solution

```
> x
      [,1]
[1,] -0.2
[2,] -0.4
[3,]  1.0
```


Summary



where we define pseudo inverse A^+ appropriately

